

Eunsun Kim

Email: eunsun.kim.phd@anderson.ucla.edu

Phone: (424) 440-5886

Education	University of California, Los Angeles, Ph.D. in Quantitative Marketing	Expected 2027
	Duke University, M.S. in Economics and Computation	2021
	Seoul National University, M.S. in Quantitative Marketing	2019
	Seoul National University, B.A. in Business <i>summa cum laude</i> ; Minor in Economics	2017
Research Interest	Quantitative Marketing, Empirical Industrial Organization, Algorithmic Pricing	
Job Market Paper	Dominant Followership in AI-Driven Algorithmic Pricing [Latest version] <i>Abstract:</i> Pricing algorithms allow firms to monitor and respond to rival price changes at scale. This paper studies how such responsiveness affects competition when firms differ in demand-side market power. Using high-frequency cross-platform pricing data, I identify sequential price adjustments and measure firms' responses to rivals' earlier price changes. Amazon's behavior is distinct: rival changes predict its later adjustments, especially same-direction responses after rival increases. To explain why this pattern affects prices, I develop a model of dominant followership. I show that a demand-advantaged follower may match rather than undercut rival price increases to monetize its existing customer base. Because this incentive operates through price responses, demand asymmetry raises prices only when the advantaged firm moves second. In Q-learning simulations, the same timing condition determines long-run outcomes: after observing rival price changes, the demand-advantaged firm learns response rules that sustain higher prices and reproduce Amazon's tendency to follow rival increases without pricing above them.	
Working Papers	Consumer-Side AI Shopping Agents and Algorithmic Pricing <i>Abstract:</i> This project studies how consumer-side AI shopping agents change competition when firms use pricing algorithms. The key feature is that agents can observe cross-platform price histories: they track relative prices across platforms and price changes over time, then choose where and when to buy. I compare demand environments that differ in the purchase rule delegated to the agent: buying from the default firm, searching across platforms before buying, or delaying purchase until a lower cross-platform price is available. The analysis asks whether access to these histories erodes dominant platforms' demand advantages by lowering search frictions and shifting consumers toward cheaper rivals, or whether default position and loyalty allow those advantages to persist.	
Honors and Research Grants	AMA-Sheth Consortium Fellow	2026
	NBER Digital Economics and AI Tutorial	2025
	Haring Symposium Fellow	2025
	ISMS Doctoral Consortium Fellow	2023, 2025
	Price Center for Entrepreneurship and Innovation Research Grant	2024
	Grand Prize, Mock Fair Trade Commission Contest, Korea Fair Trade Commission	2017
Presentations	Dean's List, Seoul National University Business School	2015, 2016
	Dominant Followership in AI-Driven Algorithmic Pricing	
	Industrial Organization Proseminar, Department of Economics, UCLA	2025, 2026
	World Congress of the Econometric Society (ESWC)	2025
	ISMS Marketing Science Conference	2025
Discussions	Artificial Intelligence in Management (AIM) Conference	2025
	Haring Symposium	2025
	California Quantitative Marketing Ph.D. Student Conference	2023, 2024

Teaching Experience	Teaching Assistant, UCLA Anderson School of Management Customer Assessment and Analytics Statistical Foundations for Data Analytics Data and Decisions	2022–present
	Teaching Assistant, Duke University Everything Data (Computer Science) Linear Algebra (Mathematics) Calculus (Mathematics)	2019–2021
	Teaching Assistant, Seoul National University Business School Data-Driven Marketing Analytics Marketing Management	2018–2019
Past Employment	Mobile Market Research, LG Display	2017
	Internship, Barun Law LLC	2015
Programming	Python, R, MATLAB, C++, $\LaTeX$	